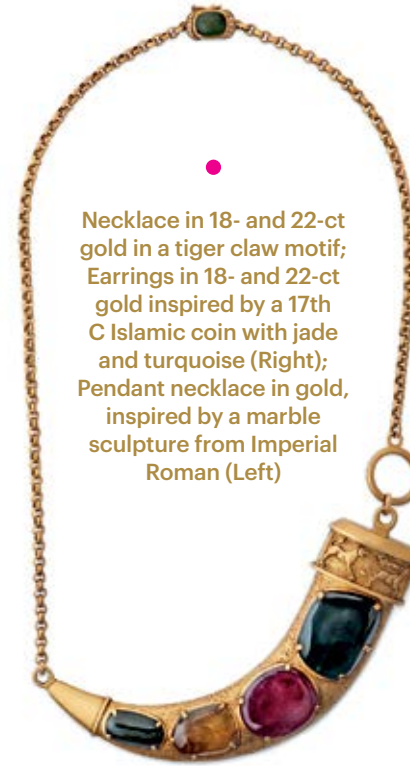




Necklace in 18- and 22-ct gold in a tiger claw motif; Earrings in 18- and 22-ct gold inspired by a 17th C Islamic coin with jade and turquoise (Right); Pendant necklace in gold, inspired by a marble sculpture from Imperial Roman (Left)

have a broad range of tastes and budgets. We aspire to appeal to this broad-ranging audience through a spectrum of Met-designed and Met-licensed products that offer quality, inspiration, and tell stories about a world of art in an authentic way. Working with licensed partners as varied as Band-Aid Brand, Pacsun, Sabyasachi, or Samsung helps us create a dynamic, art-inspired lifestyle of products that allow audiences to connect with The Met in a way that feels personal to them.

Q. How will you scale ethical, hyper-local artisan production in India to meet global retail demands of a multi-year partnership?

Sabyasachi Mukherjee You scale craft by building infrastructure around the craftsman, not by industrialising the craft out of the product.

We have spent years strengthening our manufacturing capabilities in Calcutta—training, quality control and production infrastructure. But technology and efficiency must remain support systems. They should make the artisan more productive and secure without removing the individuality of the hand.

Ethical production also cannot exist only as a marketing narrative. It has to mean continuity of employment, better working environments, skills passed forward, and craftspeople having the economic and emotional security to do their best work.

In jewellery, what that matters deeply to me is bringing Bengali karigars back to Bengal. A craftsman working close to his family, language, food and community has a different emotional relationship with his work. Global scale should ultimately create more opportunity for skilled handwork, or we have misunderstood what scale should accomplish.

Q. What are the primary cultural motifs, gemstones selections and historical inspirations that have driven the narrative of this collection, and how does the craftsmanship and material integrity reflect Sabyasachi, versus global joaillerie traditions?

Sabyasachi Mukherjee The first chapter begins with Byzantium and its sphere of influence, but the story is much wider. Byzantium existed at a crossroads of civilisations, with ideas moving through Greece, Rome, Egypt, Persia and along trade routes stretching through India eastwards. That exchange gave us an enormous visual vocabulary.

We have worked with sculptural forms, amphorae, zodiac imagery, religious iconography and details drawn from objects that could be monumental or extraordinarily intimate. The jewellery itself works through contrast. Sculptural elements in 22-carat gold are given an antiqued rouge and a sense of age, while highly finished 18-carat gold introduces precision and modern engineering. Tourmalines, garnets, sapphires, spinels and cabochons of stones such as jade, onyx, jasper and turquoise sit side by side, rejecting a hierarchy of stones and emphasising their collective power in design. I call this language Industrial Baroque— the tension between antiq-



"THE PRIVILEGE OF A MULTI-YEAR RELATIONSHIP IS THAT WE HAVE TIME. WE CAN EXPLORE WITH DEPTH RATHER THAN MANUFACTURE NOVELTY."
SAYASACHI MUKHERJEE